

OPPORTUNITY BRIEF

District Play Pass

One Pass. Every Active Experience in Your City.

Addressed to: District Play Product Team

From	Naveen Gupta, Activities and Amusements Team
Addressed To	District Play Product Team
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Type	Cross-team Opportunity Brief
Ask	To join Zomato's team and contribute working together

This brief is not a PRD. It is a structured opportunity flag from the Activities team to the Play team, identifying a market gap that District is uniquely positioned to own at a scale no current competitor can match.

01. The Opportunity in One Line

District Play Pass is a monthly active lifestyle subscription that gives users access to gyms, sports courts, run clubs, cycling groups, yoga studios, swimming pools, padel arenas, fitness studios, and every other active experience on District, all on one pass, booked slot by slot inside the app.

This is not a court-only subscription. This is the active lifestyle pass for urban India that no platform has built yet, one that covers every active experience a city has to offer, from your morning gym session to your Saturday badminton game to the run club you have been meaning to join.

FitPass is the closest reference point. It works well: pay once a month, book any gym or badminton court daily, show up across multiple locations. But FitPass is limited by its supply network, its standalone app with no lifestyle layer, and its inability to include newer trending formats like run clubs and cycling groups. District Play Pass is that product done at a larger scale, with a wider supply base, and inside an app 80 million+ Indians already use.

02. The FitPass Reference: What Works and What Is Missing

FitPass 360 is the benchmark product to understand before building District Play Pass. Here is how it actually works in practice.

A FitPass subscriber pays a monthly fee and gets access to 12,000+ gyms and fitness locations across 150+ cities in India. Each day, they open the app, choose a gym or a badminton court or a yoga studio near them, book a slot, and show up. The next day they can go to a completely different venue. There is no single-venue lock-in. The pass works across the city, across sports, across fitness formats.

This daily slot-booking model is exactly right. It solves the core problem of the active urban Indian: I want to be able to work out or play every day without paying per session, without being tied to one venue, and without planning too far in advance.

What FitPass Gets Right

What works	Why it matters
Daily slot booking across multiple venues	Users are not locked into one gym or one court. They can book wherever is convenient that day. This is the core habit loop.
Multi-format access: gyms, courts, studios	One subscription covers the gym day, the badminton morning, the yoga session. Users do not need separate memberships for each.
City-wide network across 150+ cities	Active when travelling. No pause needed. The pass works wherever the user goes.
Affordable entry point at Rs 833 per month	Lower than a single gym membership at most premium gyms. High perceived value.

Where FitPass Stops and District Play Pass Begins

Category	FitPass today	District Play Pass opportunity
Gyms and fitness centres	Covered. 12,000+ locations.	Covered. District can partner with gyms in its existing cities and expand with Zomato's vendor network and brand reach.
Sports courts (badminton, padel, football, cricket, tennis)	Available at some locations within their network.	Covered and stronger. District Play already has dedicated court supply in Delhi, Mumbai, Bengaluru across 10+ sports.
Run clubs	Not available. Zero run club integration in FitPass.	Major white space. Run clubs are one of the highest-trending active formats in Indian metro cities in 2025 and 2026. No subscription product covers them. District Play Pass can be the first.
Cycling groups	Not available.	Another trending format with zero subscription coverage. Urban cycling communities in Delhi, Mumbai, and Bengaluru are large, organised, and completely unserved by any membership product.
Swimming pools	Available at some partner locations.	Covered. District can partner with standalone pools and hotel pools in cities.
Yoga and pilates studios	Covered within their network.	Covered. District can expand into dedicated yoga and pilates studios beyond what FitPass currently has.
Lifestyle layer: movies, dining, events, amusements	Not available. FitPass is a standalone fitness app with zero lifestyle integration.	District's entire going-out ecosystem. A District Play Pass subscriber lives inside the same app they use to book movies, restaurants, amusement parks, and concerts. FitPass cannot offer this.
Brand and trust	FitPass is a standalone fitness brand with 7 million users.	Zomato has 80 million+ MAU. District inherits that trust. The credibility gap between a new FitPass subscriber and a new District Play Pass subscriber is enormous.

District Play Pass is not a FitPass clone. It is FitPass with a wider supply base, a stronger brand, and an active lifestyle ecosystem behind it that no standalone fitness subscription can replicate.

03. The Run Club Opportunity: Why This Matters Right Now

Run clubs deserve a specific section because they represent the clearest example of a high-trend, zero-competition opportunity that District Play Pass can own immediately.

Run clubs have exploded across Indian metro cities in the past two years. Every major city now has multiple organised run clubs with hundreds to thousands of members. These communities organise regular morning and evening group runs, often at specific parks, tracks, or urban routes. They charge no or very low per-session fees and are held together by WhatsApp groups and Instagram communities.

The problem is that run clubs have no infrastructure. There is no booking system. There is no membership product. There is no way for a new runner to discover which run clubs exist in their city, when they meet, and how to join them. Everything is informal.

District Play Pass can solve this for run clubs the same way District Play solved it for badminton courts: create a structured, bookable experience inside the District app. Run club organisers get a platform. Members get a discoverable, bookable, subscription-friendly format. District gets a new supply category with zero competition.

Active format	Current state	District Play Pass opportunity
Run clubs	Entirely informal. WhatsApp and Instagram-based. No booking. No membership product anywhere in India.	First mover. District can onboard run club organisers as venue partners, make their sessions bookable, and include them in the Play Pass.
Cycling groups	Same as run clubs. Community-organised, no booking infrastructure, no subscription product.	Same opportunity. District can be the first platform to make cycling group sessions discoverable and bookable.
Open-air yoga and fitness classes	Some parks and outdoor venues run paid sessions informally. No platform aggregates them.	District can include outdoor fitness sessions in the Play Pass network, expanding beyond gym walls.

04. Who Buys District Play Pass

User	Current behavior	Why Play Pass converts them
Naveen, 22 Jaipur and metro cities Goes to the gym daily and plays badminton in the morning using FitPass 360	Pays FitPass monthly. Books gym slots and badminton courts daily through their app. Happy with the model but limited by FitPass's supply network and no lifestyle integration.	District Play Pass offers the same daily slot-booking model with a wider supply network, run clubs and cycling groups FitPass does not have, and the entire District ecosystem in the same app. This is a direct upgrade from FitPass.
Priya, 26 Bengaluru Wants to join a run club but does not know where to start	Follows run club Instagram accounts. Has been meaning to join but the informal nature makes it hard to show up consistently. Does not know how to find sessions near her.	District Play Pass makes run clubs discoverable and bookable. She books a morning run session the same way she books a badminton court. The subscription removes the activation barrier.

User	Current behavior	Why Play Pass converts them
Rohan, 29 Mumbai Plays football on weekends, goes to gym on weekdays, wants to try padel	Has a gym membership at one venue. Books football turfs per session on District Play. Has not tried padel because each new sport feels like a new per-session commitment to justify.	One Play Pass covers gym, football, and a padel trial session. Every active format in his city on one monthly fee. No per-session hesitation.
Corporate wellness buyer HR manager at a 200-person tech company in Delhi NCR	Company offers FitPass as an employee wellness benefit. Employees who prefer sports courts over gyms feel underserved by the current offering.	District Play Pass is pitched as the active lifestyle upgrade to a FitPass corporate plan. Covers gym, court, run club, yoga, and more. HR buys in bulk. District gets a B2B acquisition channel with low CAC.

05. Proposed Product Structure

This is directional. Pricing and session counts are starting points based on observed market rates. The Play team would validate against actual booking data and venue settlement economics.

What District Play Pass Covers

Gyms and fitness centres | Badminton, padel, tennis, squash courts | Football, cricket, and basketball turfs | Swimming pools | Yoga and pilates studios | Cycling groups | Run clubs | Outdoor fitness and boot camp sessions

Subscription Tiers

Tier	Price/month	What you get	Best for
Play Pass Lite	Rs 599	8 sessions per month across any format in your city. Gyms, courts, run clubs, studios. Sessions expire at month end.	Light active user. Goes out 2 times a week. Wants flexibility without a full gym membership commitment.
Play Pass Regular	Rs 1,299	20 sessions per month. Any format, any District Play partner venue. Up to 4 unused sessions roll over to next month.	Daily active user. The core segment. Gym on weekdays, court or run club on weekends. This is the FitPass switcher tier.
Play Pass Pro	Rs 2,199	Unlimited sessions at standard and off-peak slots. Up to 6 peak-hour slots per month. Priority booking 48 hours ahead.	Multi-sport enthusiast or fitness-first user who is active 5 to 6 days a week. Power user and word-of-mouth driver.
Annual plans	10 to 15% off any tier	Pre-paid 12-month access. Maximum switching cost and locked-in GMV.	Committed users. Highest LTV. Target for corporate wellness deals.

How It Works: The Daily Experience

This is the experience District Play Pass must deliver to win against FitPass. The friction of daily booking must be as low as or lower than what FitPass offers today.

- User opens District app in the morning. Taps Play. Taps Play Pass.
- Sees their session balance: 14 sessions remaining this month.
- Browses nearby options: 3 gyms available at 6 AM, 2 badminton courts at 7 AM, 1 run club session at 6:30 AM at Cubbon Park.
- Taps the run club session. Sees: organiser name, route, distance, pace group, number of people joining.
- Taps Book with Play Pass. One session deducted. Confirmation sent. Done in under 30 seconds.
- Next day they book a gym slot the same way. The day after, a padel court. Same app, same pass, different experience every day.

The Run Club Experience Specifically

Run clubs require a slightly different onboarding than courts or gyms because they are community-led, not venue-led. District would need to onboard run club organisers as partners. Here is how it works:

- Run club organiser lists their sessions on District Play: location, day, time, pace group (beginner, intermediate, advanced), maximum participants.
- Each session appears as a bookable slot inside District Play, the same way a badminton court appears.
- Play Pass subscribers book a spot the same way they book a court. One session deducted from their balance.
- Organiser gets a confirmed headcount before the run. District settles a per-session fee with the organiser, making it worthwhile for them to formalise their community on the platform.
- Non-subscribers can also book run club sessions on a pay-per-session basis, giving District Play a new supply category that attracts new users organically.

06. Why District Wins This

Advantage	Why it matters
Zomato has 80 million+ MAU vs FitPass's 7 million users	District Play Pass launches with access to a user base more than 10 times larger than FitPass's entire current user count. The top-of-funnel advantage is structural, not earned.
District Play already has court supply in 3 cities	FitPass had to build its entire supply network from scratch. District Play Pass launches day one with badminton courts, padel arenas, football turfs, cricket nets, basketball courts, and swimming pools already onboarded across Delhi, Mumbai, and Bengaluru.
Run clubs and cycling groups: zero competition	No subscription product in India covers run clubs or cycling groups. FitPass does not. Nobody does. District Play Pass can be the first platform to make these formats bookable and subscription-accessible. This is a clean first-mover position.
The lifestyle ecosystem moat	FitPass is a standalone fitness app. District is where users already book movies, restaurants, events, and amusement parks. A user whose gym, badminton court, run club, movie tickets, and Saturday dinner reservation all live in one app has zero reason to switch to a competitor for any single category.
Zomato brand trust lowers subscription conversion barrier	Asking a user to set up a new monthly subscription on an unfamiliar app requires trust-building. District Play Pass is asking the same user to subscribe on an app they already have, already use, and already trust with their payment details.
Corporate wellness B2B channel	Companies that offer FitPass as a wellness benefit are a warm prospect base for District Play Pass. The pitch is simple: same slot-booking model, wider supply, run clubs and cycling groups included, all inside the District app your employees already use.

07. Revenue Logic

These are directional components. The Play team would need to validate unit economics with actual session pricing and venue settlement data.

Revenue component	How it works
Monthly subscription fees	Collected upfront at the start of each billing cycle. Predictable, recurring GMV. The subscription fee is collected regardless of how many sessions the user actually redeems that month.
Breakage revenue	The percentage of subscribers who consistently do not use all their sessions each month. Unused sessions cost District nothing in settlement fees. Breakage is margin. Industry subscription products typically see 20 to 40% breakage. This is the margin engine of the entire model.
Settlement spread per session redeemed	District pays partner venues a negotiated per-session rate when a Play Pass session is used. The spread between the subscription revenue collected and the total settlement paid out to venues is District's gross margin on redeemed sessions.

Revenue component	How it works
Annual plan upfront GMV	Annual subscribers pay 10 to 12 months upfront. 12 months of GMV locked in with zero churn risk for that period. High-value LTV cohort that also generates the most word-of-mouth.
Corporate wellness B2B contracts	HR teams buy Play Pass subscriptions in bulk for employees. Corporate accounts have lower CAC, higher commitment, and longer tenure than individual subscribers. This mirrors how FitPass generates a significant share of its revenue through corporate tie-ups.
Pay-per-session for non-subscribers on new formats	Run clubs and cycling groups brought onto District Play attract non-subscriber users who book on a pay-per-session basis. This grows the total Play addressable audience and creates a natural funnel into Play Pass subscriptions.

08. Key Questions for the Play Team

This brief is a starting point. These are the questions the Play team would need to answer before committing to build.

#	Question	Why it matters
Q1	What is the current average booking frequency per District Play user per month? Are users already booking 8 to 20 sessions a month, or are they mostly one-off bookers?	The subscription only makes sense for a user who is already active multiple times a week. If median frequency is once a month, the value proposition is weak.
Q2	What is the average revenue per session by format (gym vs court vs studio) and what per-session settlement rate would venues accept within a subscription model?	The business model lives or dies on this number. The Play team has this data. The Activities team does not.
Q3	How many run clubs and cycling group organisers are active in Delhi, Mumbai, and Bengaluru and would they formalise onto District Play as bookable sessions?	Run clubs are the biggest differentiator versus FitPass. If supply acquisition is too hard, this advantage weakens. A quick outreach to 10 to 15 run club organisers in each city would answer this.
Q4	Would top District Play venues (premium padel courts, high-demand cricket turfs) opt into a subscription model or would they only allow Play Pass on low-demand slots?	A Play Pass that only unlocks off-peak slots at mediocre venues has weak perceived value. The quality of opted-in supply matters as much as the quantity.
Q5	Is there an opportunity to offer District Play Pass as an upgrade tier within an existing District membership or Zomato Gold framework, or does it stand alone?	Bundling Play Pass with an existing District or Zomato Gold membership could dramatically reduce acquisition friction. Worth evaluating before designing the standalone subscription architecture.

09. Suggested Next Steps

The Activities team is flagging this opportunity because the supply overlap between Activities and Play, and the run club whitespace specifically, became visible during work on the Activities vertical. The build decision sits entirely with the District Play team.

If the opportunity looks compelling, the Activities team suggests three quick validation steps before any PRD work begins:

- Data pull by Play Analytics (2 weeks): current booking frequency per user, average session revenue by format, and top-performing venues by booking volume. These two data points immediately tell you whether the subscription economics are viable.
- User research (1 week): conversations with 10 to 15 current District Play power users (4 or more sessions booked in the past 30 days) and separately with 5 to 10 active FitPass users who also play sports. Understand what they would pay for a wider pass and whether the run club and cycling group inclusion is genuinely exciting to them.
- Run club supply check (1 week): identify 5 to 10 organised run clubs in each of the three District Play cities. Have a single conversation with each organiser about whether they would formalise sessions onto District. This tells you whether the biggest differentiator is buildable before a single line of PRD is written.

Naveen Gupta | Aspiring Product Manager |

FitPass proved the model works. District Play Pass is that model with a 10x larger user base, wider supply, and an ecosystem no standalone fitness app can compete with.